



M1 electric skateboard

The InBoard is an electric skateboard with swappable batteries, that lets you skate for 11 kms on a single charge. <https://digit.in/Aug18-35-1>



A better Echo

Cavalier Audio's Maverick, with Alexa built in, is essentially a much better looking version of the Amazon Echo. <https://digit.in/Aug18-35-2>

ASUS TUF FX504 Gaming Laptop

Not necessarily tough



For visuals, we see diagonal cuts over a brushed metal texture on the top surface of the FX504 with the ASUS branding bang in the centre. The underside has a few similar marks along with roughly one half of the area occupied by intake vents. The laptop is easily serviceable once the 11 screws are removed. There are four rubberised feet to give the ASUS TUF FX504 some traction as well. While the internals are well protected, it certainly does not mirror the tough-image that ASUS is trying to portray.

The right hand side has a Kensington lock slot and is devoid of any other I/O ports. At the very edge, we see the speaker grille. On the left hand side, there are two USB 3.1, one USB 2.0, an HDMI, Ethernet, power and a 3.5mm audio I/O port. ASUS has been unable to squeeze in an SD card slot, although there seems to be plenty of space inside to do so. The TUF FX504 has the indicator LEDs placed right at the top edge, which remain visible regardless of the position of the lid (closed/open).

The hinges are fairly standard and rigid and allow the unit to open up by 140 degrees. The keyboard comes with red backlighting and follows the full layout. ASUS says the switches are rated for 20 million key presses and actuate with 62 grams of force. The actuation point for the keys are said to be a bit higher than the average. The touchpad is fairly huge with integrated buttons. The surface texture is smoother and the matte finish works better with tracking.

Performance Storage

The ASUS TUF FX504 uses an 128 GB NVMe SSD from Kingston which is



tests, we managed to get uplink speeds of 281 Mb/s and about 432 Mb/s on the downlink.

Gaming

The ASUS TUF FX504 has the obvious advantage of having the newer 6-core Core i7-8750H CPU which easily tops the previous gen quad-core 7700HQ. That along with the GTX 1050 Ti is bound to allow higher FPS in titles which would have been bottlenecked by the CPU. Synthetic benchmarks show a remarkable increase in scores with 3D Mark Fire

Strike scoring 7068 and TimeSpy getting 2556 points. On the CPU front, we see a score of 105.36 in Cinebench with the Intel Core i7-8750H as compared to 92.86 that we've managed in a similar configuration with the Intel Core i7-7700HQ. That's quite a lot.

As for gaming, we managed to get 67 FPS in Rise of the Tomb Raider and 81 FPS in Bioshock Infinite. These are higher than what we've seen with the Intel Core i7-7700HQ but the gap isn't as wide as we saw in the CPU tests.

Verdict

The ASUS TUF Gaming FX504 is a great gaming laptop given that you've got the additional 2 CPU cores for no added money. While the overall specs and performance make it a good product, we don't believe that the overall design is any "tougher" than what's usually found in this price range. At the end of the day, the FX504 offers way better value for money.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7-8750H | PLATFORM: HM370 | RAM: 8 GB 2667 MHz | SCREEN SIZE: 15.6-inches 120Hz | SCREEN RESOLUTION: 1920x1080 | GPU: GTX 1050 Ti 4 GB GDDR5X | SSD: 128 GB NVMe | HDD: Seagate FireCuda 1 TB | BATTERY: 48 Whr | AC ADAPTER: 120 W | WEIGHT: 2.3 kg

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just about enough to house the boot drive and perhaps a couple of other software. ASUS is using the Seagate FireCuda 1 TB SSHD which performs better than the traditional HDDs. So instead of having a superfast SSD clubbed with a slow HDD,

ASUS has gone for a mid-range NVMe SSD and an SSHD giving a better experience. While synthetic benchmarks don't highlight this right away, normal use does. The FireCuda clocks in at 128 MB/s (read) and 117 MB/s (write).

Screen

The ASUS TUF FX504 sports a 120 Hz panel in a price range where 60 Hz is the norm. The display panel does not come calibrated out of the box. Since this is a TN panel, the colours are not up to the mark and the luminance uniformity is off as well with DeltaE values close to 3.

Wi-Fi

For Wi-Fi and Bluetooth, the ASUS TUF FX504 uses the Intel 9560NGW which is an 802.11ac 2T2R module with built-in Bluetooth 5.0. In our